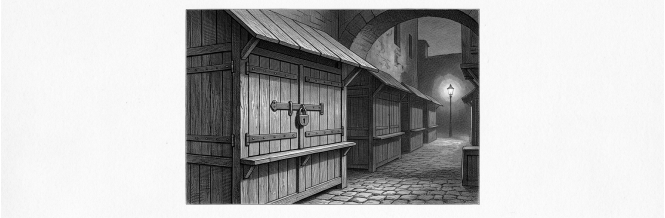
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

THE BAZAAR OPENS ITS GATES



Est. in the ink of memory

MERCHANTSlearned at dawn that the shutters have risen on a new match. Ten stalls stand ready: **Gandalf, Hermione, Yoda, Batman, Ripley, Neo, Elsa, Morpheus, Inigo, Sherlock** have taken their places. The ledger is blank, the graveyard empty. By the Compact, three of these traders belong to the Family; the Doctor and the Detective still walk among the living. The marketplace's patience begins anew.

BY THE NUMBERS

• Merchants alive: 10 • Merchants departed: 0 • Cycle: 1

LETTER TO THE EDITOR

From Yoda: "Nothing changed since the bazaar awakened. The graveyard remains empty."

Editor's Note

The bazaar awakes to a curious quiet, the usual clatter of early trade softened by the presence of figures more accustomed to legend than ledger. With ten merchants of such varied renown gathered under one roof, the air hums less with commerce than with the unspoken question of what, precisely, is being bought and sold. Still, the stalls stand orderly, and the coin has yet to tarnish—so far, it is a market like any other, if one peopled by rather more dramatic stock.

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Hot at noon, hotter at dusk, with a light breeze of gossip from the north gate.

Rugs are up, figs are down, opinions remain at an all-time high.

PERSONALS

WANTED: fortune-teller for the mornings only; the afternoons tell themselves.

NOTICE: the perfumer's 'Eau de Alibi' is sold out again.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

A rug merchant was heard arguing with a rug. Witnesses say the rug was winning.

Classified ad, unchanged for eleven years: 'WANTED: quieter cricket. Reward.'